

## Chocolate houses

In the 16th century, European **CONQUISTADORS** arrived in the Americas and discovered the cacao beans. Realizing the commercial opportunity, Spanish conqueror Hernando Cortéz sweetened the chocolatl drink with cane sugar to cater to European tastes. In the 17th century, **fashionable chocolate houses** were popping up across Europe, allowing high society to savor the new taste. **Only the wealthy** could afford this sweet treat.



## Birth of the bar

In 1828, Dutch chemist Casparus Van Houten invented **powdered chocolate** or “Dutch cocoa.”

Englishman Joseph Fry then added melted cocoa butter to Dutch cocoa in 1847, producing chocolate paste. **SOLID CHOCOLATE** was born! In 1868, English chocolate company Cadbury began making and marketing **bars of chocolate**. The tasty new treat quickly spread around the world.

## How it changed the world

Chocolate is one of the world's favorite flavors, and one of the most lucrative: The modern chocolate industry is expected to be worth a mouthwatering \$98.3 billion by 2016. Although doctors recommend consuming chocolate in moderation, scientists are investigating the many chemicals in chocolate, searching for health benefits.

Known as “the Great American Chocolate Bar,” the **HERSHEY BAR** went on sale in 1900. It became one of the world's best-selling chocolate bars.



The founding of the **NEW YORK COCOA EXCHANGE** in 1925 recognized cocoa as an important **COMMODITY** that could be bought and sold on the open market.